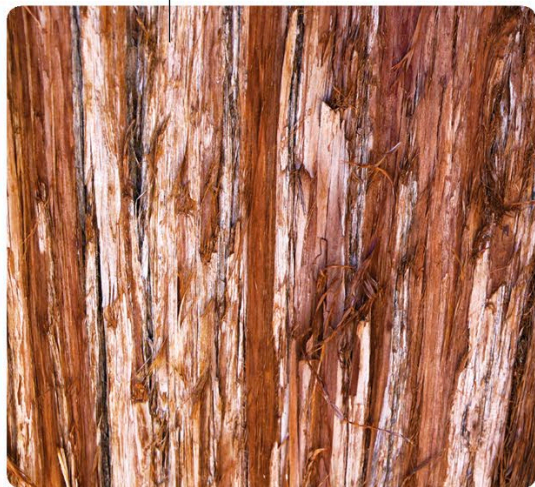




Barking up the tree

The red-brown bark can be up to 11 in (30 cm) thick.



Fibrous
(Coast redwood)

The green inner bark turns blue, purple, and orange when exposed to the air.



Vertical stripes
(Manchurian striped maple)

The bright green bark with white stripes is easily damaged in strong sunlight.



Spiny
(Silk floss)

Cone-shaped spines protect this greenish gray bark against animals.

Unusual rectangular plates make it easy to identify a persimmon tree's bark.



Plates
(Persimmon)

This smooth gray bark can be infected by deadly fungi.



Smooth
(American beech)

Bark is the woody “skin” that protects the trunks of trees and stems of shrubs, forming a barrier against disease and grazing animals, while keeping water in. Bark is essentially dead tissue—a tough layer formed as the living cells underneath it die and are replaced.

Tree bark comes in many different patterns and textures and is vital to the health of a tree. The fibrous bark of the **coast redwood** is extremely fire-resistant, while the spines on **silk floss** bark deter any hungry animals from eating the young branches. Since all trunks need air to